

MODERN ENGLISH

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

(Prescribed Texts)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for only reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **five** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Section A, you are required to write only **ONE** option as the correct answer.
7. Internal choice has been given in the long answer questions on Drama, Prose and Poetry.
8. Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions in Section B.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

Kindly read aloud the Instructions given above to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

SECTION A – 20 MARKS

Question 1

Choose the correct options for the following questions.

- (i) In Act III of the play, *Pygmalion*, Higgins assures his mother that Eliza has been told to keep to two subjects at the 'at home'. What are they? (*Recall*) [1]
- (a) Music and the theatre
 - (b) The weather and everybody's health
 - (c) Flowers and fashion
 - (d) Her family and her lessons
- (ii) How does Clara Eynsford Hill react to Eliza's startling remarks at the 'at home' in Act III of *Pygmalion*? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) She takes them to be the fashionable 'new small talk' and copies them.
 - (b) She is deeply offended and leaves at once.
 - (c) She guesses that Eliza is a flower girl.
 - (d) She asks Higgins to stop the conversation.

- (iii) Read the two statements about the play, *Pygmalion* and choose the correct option from the ones given below. [1]
Statement I: Higgins wins his bet when Eliza passes as a lady at the ambassador's reception.
Statement II: Alone with Higgins at midnight, Eliza asks what is to become of her now.
(Understand)
 (a) Statements I and II are similar.
 (b) Statement I and II are unrelated to each other.
 (c) Statement I is the result of Statement II.
 (d) Statement II is the result of Statement I.
- (iv) In Act V of *Pygmalion*, what have Higgins and Pickering done on discovering that Eliza has left Wimpole Street? *(Recall)* [1]
 (a) They have gone to the police.
 (b) They have sent Freddy to look for her.
 (c) They have written to Doolittle.
 (d) They have advertised in the newspapers.
- (v) In the short story, *The Dreamer*, what does Adela Chemping say about herself and bargains? *(Understand)* [1]
 (a) She is a hardened bargain hunter.
 (b) She hates sales and avoids them.
 (c) She is no bargain hunter, but likes to go where bargains are.
 (d) She shops only for her nephews.
- (vi) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, which part of the doll's house does Kezia like most? *(Recall)* [1]
 (a) The red plush furniture
 (b) The kitchen stove
 (c) The little amber lamp
 (d) The father and mother dolls
- (vii) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, what does Charles find in the trash barrel in the garage? *(Recall)* [1]
 (a) A broken garden rake
 (b) The dried, empty skin of his real father
 (c) A can of kerosene
 (d) A nest of silver insects
- (viii) In the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, in which month does the tomato 'invade' the kitchen? *(Recall)* [1]
 (a) June
 (b) March
 (c) September
 (d) December

- (ix) In the poem, *Refugee Blues*, what does the consul mean when he says that without a passport the refugees are 'officially dead'? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) They have been reported killed in the war.
 (b) They have no legal existence in the eyes of the state.
 (c) They will soon be executed.
 (d) They are too ill to travel.
- (x) In the poem, *Urban*, why are the hills 'always far away' for the man? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) He is too old to climb them.
 (b) His city life keeps him cut off from nature.
 (c) They are hidden by fog.
 (d) He dislikes the countryside.

Question 2

Answer any **five** of the following subparts in 40-50 words.

- (i) In Act III of *Pygmalion*, why does Mrs Higgins warn the two men about what is to be done with Eliza afterwards? (*Understand*) [2]
- (ii) In Act IV of *Pygmalion*, why does Eliza hand back the ring, and how does Higgins react? (*Understand*) [2]
- (iii) In the short story, *The Dreamer*, why was Cyprian not wearing a hat? (*Recall*) [2]
- (iv) In the short story, *Games at Twilight*, why is the shed frightening to Ravi? (*Understand*) [2]
- (v) In the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, what does the poet mean by saying that the summer light is 'halved like a tomato'? (*Interpret*) [2]
- (vi) In the poem, *Urban*, what is meant by saying that the man moves in circles 'tracked within his head'? (*Interpret*) [2]

SECTION B – 60 MARKS

PYGMALION: GEORGE BERNARD SHAW

Question 3

- (i) In Act IV of *Pygmalion*, Eliza quarrels bitterly with Higgins after the reception. Why does she lose her temper, and what does her question about her future reveal? [5]
- Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Understand*)
- Eliza's anger and the slippers
 - Her question: what is to become of her?
- (ii) Describe Alfred Doolittle's appearance and complaint in Act V of *Pygmalion*. What does Shaw satirise through him? [5]
- Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Interpret*)
- His new condition and whom he blames
 - The satire on middle-class morality

- (iii) **(a)** Eliza says that the difference between a lady and a flower girl lies not in how she behaves but in how she is treated. Discuss this statement with close reference to Higgins and Pickering in Acts III to V. [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Analyse*)

OR

- (b)** Shaw calls *Pygmalion* 'a romance', yet refuses to let Eliza marry Higgins. Is the play a romance? Give reasons for your answer with reference to the ending and to Shaw's sequel. [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

PERSPECTIVES: A COLLECTION OF SHORT STORIES

Question 4

- (i) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, what does Charles see in the garage, and how does he know that the man at the dinner table is not his father? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Understand*)
- The scene in the garage
 - The signs at the dinner table
- (ii) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, why are the Kelvey sisters shunned, and how do they respond when Lena Logan taunts them? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Understand*)
- Reasons for their exclusion
 - Lil's and Else's response
- (iii) **(a)** In the short story, *Games at Twilight*, why is Ravi forgotten by the other children, and what lies at the centre of his heartbreak? [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Analyse*)

OR

- (b)** Referring closely to the short story, *Death by Scrabble*, explain the ending. In your opinion, is the narrator's death caused by the game, by coincidence or by his own mind? [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

REFLECTIONS: A COLLECTION OF POEMS

Question 5

- (i) In the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, describe the condition of the house after the grandmother's death. What does it reveal about the speaker's feelings? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (*Understand*)
- The physical state of the house
 - Its atmosphere and the speaker's feelings

- (ii) In the poem, *The Black Santa*, how is the Black Santa different from the Santa Claus the child knows from television and advertisements? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(Understand)

- His physical appearance
- His clothing, manner and what he means to the child

- (iii) (a) How does the poem, *Refugee Blues*, convey the refugees' loss of home, identity and dignity? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Analyse)

OR

- (b) Examine the devices Nissim Ezekiel uses in the poem, *Urban*, to portray the alienation of the modern city-dweller. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Analyse)

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